Week 5
Morphology

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internal use only

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1. Types of morphemes

1.1. Definition of morphemes

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1. Definition of Morphemes 1

- **A morpheme** is the …….. …… unit in a language.
- Like the phoneme, the morpheme refers to either a class of forms or an …….. from the concrete forms of language.

E.g.:

- Grammatical morphemes: ***a, in, can, plural morpheme, present tense morpheme.***
- Lexical morpheme: ***book, eat, "-er", "re-"***

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1. Definition of Morphemes 1

Characteristics	
Internally ……	it cannot be further subdivided or analyzed into smaller meaningful units.
Internally ……..	nothing can be interposed in a morpheme
Externally ……	it has positional mobility or free distribution, occurring in various context

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1. Definition of Morphemes 1

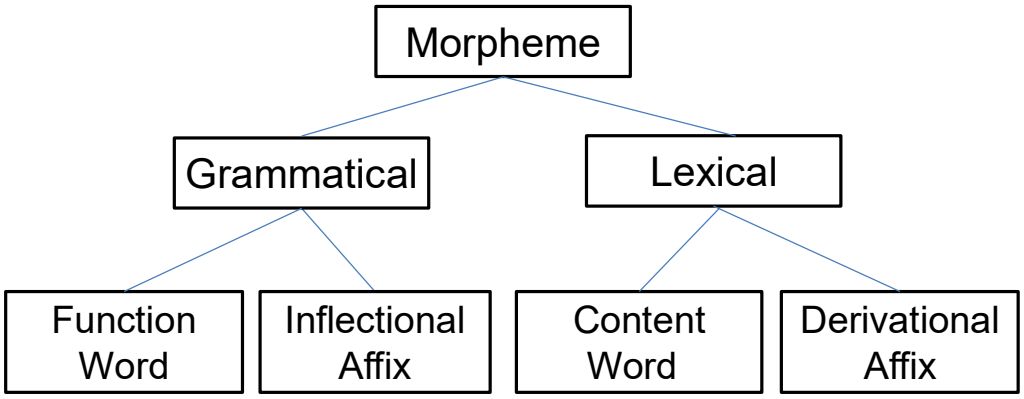
- Identify the morphemes in the following sentence:

  The police reopened the investigation.

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2. Types of morphemes

1



This classification is based primarily on ……....

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2. Types of morphemes

1

Grammatical morphemes	Lexical morphemes
Express a ……of common meanings, or express relations within the sentence.	Express lexical / dictionary meaning.
Their occurrence is …….... by the grammar of the sentence .	Categorized into word classes: *noun, verb, adjective, adverb*
Constitute closed word classes. Can be exhaustively listed.	Constitute open categories i.e. new members can be ……
Are parts of words i.e. *inflectional affixes,* or small but independent 'function words' belonging to the minor word classes i.e. *prepositions*.	Are generally independent words (free roots) or parts of words (derivational affixes and bound roots).

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Examples

Grammatical morphemes	Lexical morphemes
• Function words:	• Content words:
- Pronouns, Prepositions, Auxiliary verbs, Conjunctions, Determiners	- Nouns - Verbs - Adjectives - Adverbs
• Inflectional affixes:	• Derivational affixes
- "-s / es": Singular/Plural;	- Prefixes: "re-, un- , dis-
- "-er", "-est": Comparison	- Suffixes:
- "-ing", "-ed": Participle	▪ Noun suffixes: ▪ Verb suffixes: ▪ Adjective suffixes: ▪ Adverb suffixes:

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2. Morphemes versus morphs

2.1. Definition of Morphs

2.2. Types of Morphs

2.3. Morphemes vs. Morphs

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1. Definition of Morphs

2

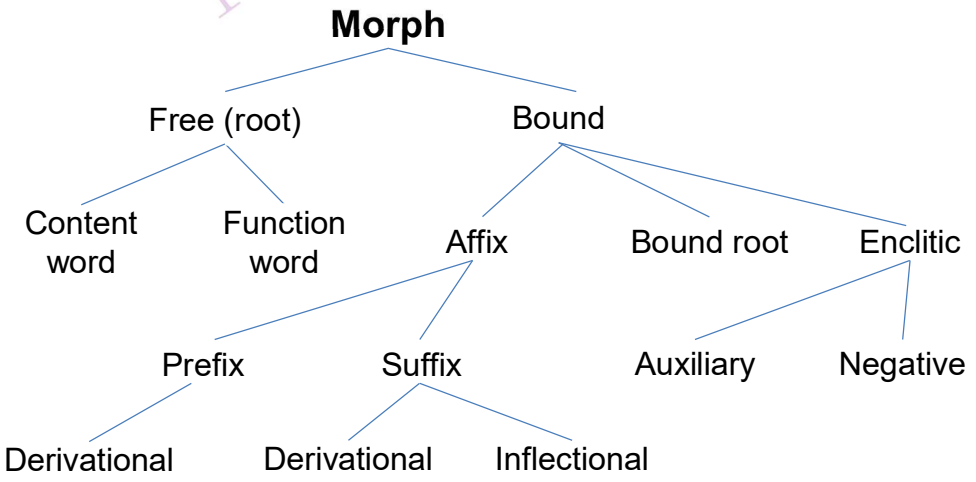
- **A morph** is the …… realization of a morpheme.
- This classification is based primarily on …… .

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2. Types of morphs

2



This classification is based primarily on …… .

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2. Types of morphs

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Free morphs	Bound morphs
Can stand by themselves as single words.	Cannot normally stand alone and are always …….. another morph.
Is always a **root** morpheme.	
Carries the principal lexical or grammatical …… .	Doesn't carry the ……. meaning.
E.g. open, tour, un***avoid***ably	E.g. re-, -ist, -ed, -s, -'s
May …… other free or bound morphemes. E.g.: unavoidably, overgrown, Disheartened, reclassify.	**Roots** are occasionally **bound morphs** (or bound roots) **.** E.g.: **-vert** in convert, revert **- mit**: in transmit, permit **- ceive**: in conceive, receive

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Examples

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Undressed

Un- **dress** **-ed**

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2. Types of morphs

2

Derivational affixes	Inflectional affixes
Can either be a …… or ……..	Is always a ……
Can be more than …….. ~ per word.	Maybe **only** …… ~ per word.
A particular ~ may attach to only a …… number of roots.	A particular ~ may attach to all or most members of a certain word class.
Function: - Convert one part of speech to another (……). - Change the meaning of the root (……...).	**Function:** - Indicate grammatical meaning/ aspect of a word.
Always …… an inflectional affix.	Always occur ……

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2. Types of morphs

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- **An enclitic** is a kind of ……., a bound form which derives from an …… word and must be attached to the preceding word.
- **Two kinds of enclitics**:
  - Auxiliaries: attached to the preceding subject (He'll, she'd, I've, You're, I'm)
  - Negative *–n't:* attached to the preceding auxiliary (won't, mustn't, hasn't, wasn't)

This classification is based primarily on **MEANING**.

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2. Types of morphs

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A Root ≠	**A Base**,	which is a ROOT + associated derivational affixes, to which …… are added.
	A Stem,	which is a ROOT + associated derivational affixes, to which …… are added.

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Root, Base, Stem

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en – gage – ment – s

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Morphological description

- Identify 11 morphemes and their types in the following sentence:

The child's wildness shocked the teachers.

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3. **Morphemic** analysis vs. **Morphological** analysis

- Not always a ……. correspondence between morph and morphemes.
- Morphemes can combine or be realized in a number of different ways.

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3. **Morphemic** analysis vs. **Morphological** analysis

- **Morphological analysis**: words are analyzed into …….. (following formal divisions).
- **Morphemic analysis**: words are analyzed into …….. (recognizing the abstract units of meaning present).

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Nouns

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	Morphological Analysis	Morphemic Analysis
Writers	3 morphs	3 morphemes
	writ/er/s	{WRITE} + {ER}+ {pl}
Authors	2 morphs	2 morphemes
	author/s	……
Mice	1 morph	2 morphemes
	……	{MOUSE} + {pl}
Fish	1 morph	2 morphemes
	fish	{FISH} + {pl}

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Nouns

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	Morphological Analysis	Morphemic Analysis
Children	2 morphs	2 morphemes
	Child/ren	{CHILD} + {pl}
Teeth	1 morph	2 morphemes
	teeth	{TOOTH} + {pl}
Man's	2 morphs	2 morphemes
	man/ s	{MAN} + {poss}
Men's	2 morphs	3 morphemes
	men/ s	{MAN} + {pl} + {poss}

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Nouns

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	Morphological Analysis	Morphemic Analysis
Sheep	1 morph	2 morphemes
	Sheep	{SHEEP} + {pl}
		{SHEEP} + {sg}

NOTE:
If a morpheme is postulated for singular, we can account for number systematically

	Morphological Analysis	Morphemic Analysis
Author	1 morph	2 morphemes
	Author	{AUTHOR} + {sg}

Adjectives

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	Morphological Analysis	Morphemic Analysis
Smaller	2 morphs	2 morphemes
	small/er	{SMALL} + {comp}
Smallest	2 morphs	2 morphemes
	Small/est	{SMALL} + {supl}
better	1 morph	2 morphemes
	better	……
best	1 morph	2 morphemes
	best	{GOOD} + {supl}
Good	1 morph	2 morphemes
	Good	{GOOD} + {pos}

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Verbs

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	Morphological Analysis	Morphemic Analysis
worked	2 morphs	2 morphemes
	work/ed	…… ……
wrote	1 morph	2 morphemes
	Wrote	{WRITE} + {past}
Written	1 morph	2 morphemes
	Written	{WRITE} + {pastprt}
Working	2 morphs	2 morphemes
	Work/ing	{work} + {prsprt}
		3 morphemes
		……

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Verbs

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NOTE:

-ing verbal forms can be analyzed as present participle or gerund.

Since gerunds are functioning as nouns, they may be pluralized.

	Morphological Analysis	Morphemic Analysis
Sittings	3 morphs	3 morphemes
	sitt/ing/s	{SIT} + {gerund} + {pl}

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Verbs

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NOTE:

A morpheme need to be postulated {pres} to account coherently for the distinction ***past*** vs ***present***.

	Morphological Analysis	Morphemic Analysis
Work	1 morph	2 morphemes
	work	{WORK} + {pres}
write	1 morph	2 morphemes
	Write	{WRITE} + {pres}

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Pronouns

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	Morphological Analysis	Morphemic Analysis
we	1 morph	3 morphemes
	We	{1st p} + {pl} + {nomn}
him	1 morph	4 morphemes
	him	{3rd p} + {sg} + {m} + {obj}
its	2 morphs	4 morphemes
	It/s	{3rd p} + {sg} + {n} + {poss}

NOTE:
Nomn = nominative case
Obj = objective case

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